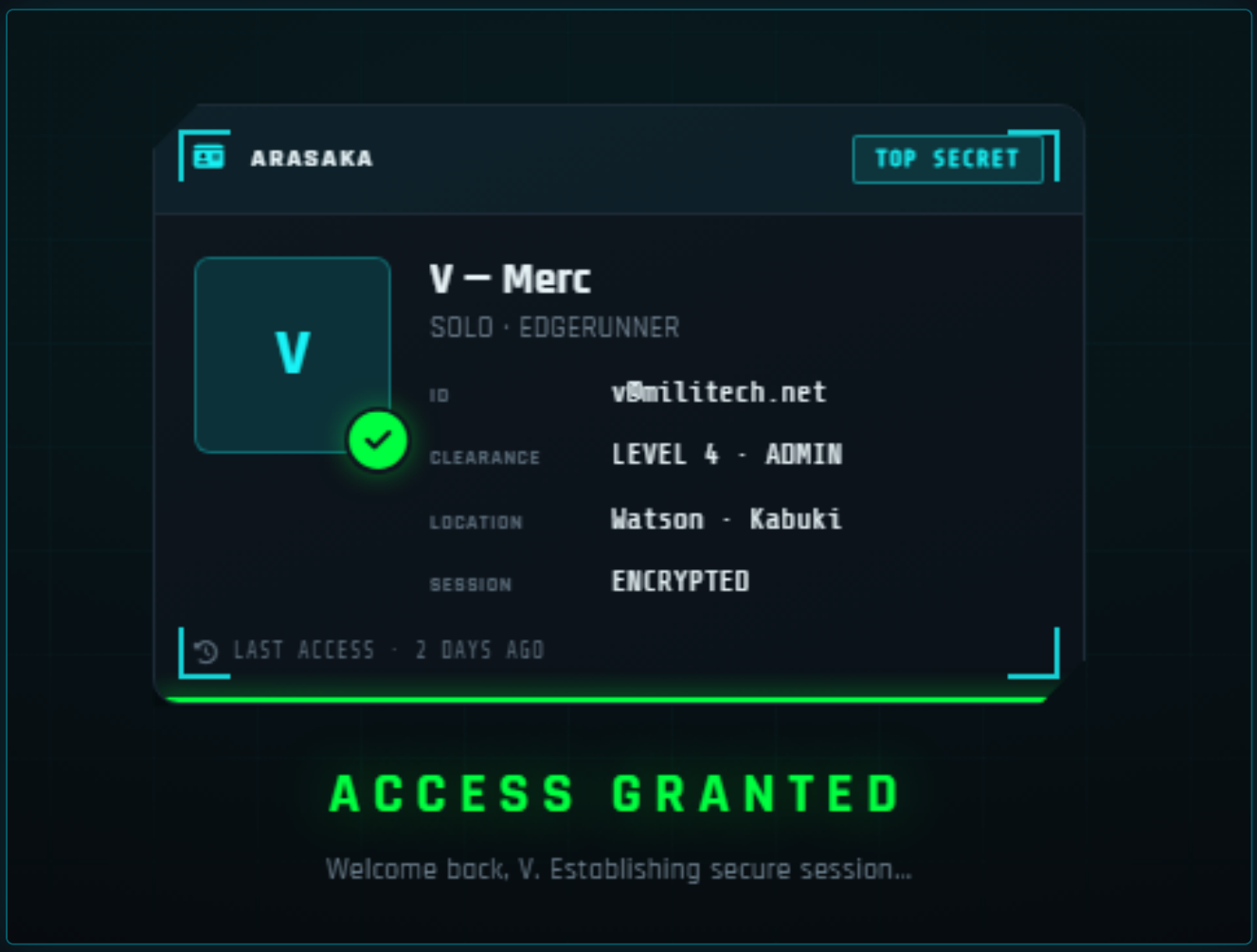
// A MODULE FOR FOUNDRY VTT + CYBERPUNK RED

NIGHT CITY MESSENGER

Player Guide



github.com/christinophrappuccino/night-city-messenger

Your character's phone, mail and hacking tools. This guide covers everything a player needs. Your GM decides which parts your game uses, so you may not see all of it.

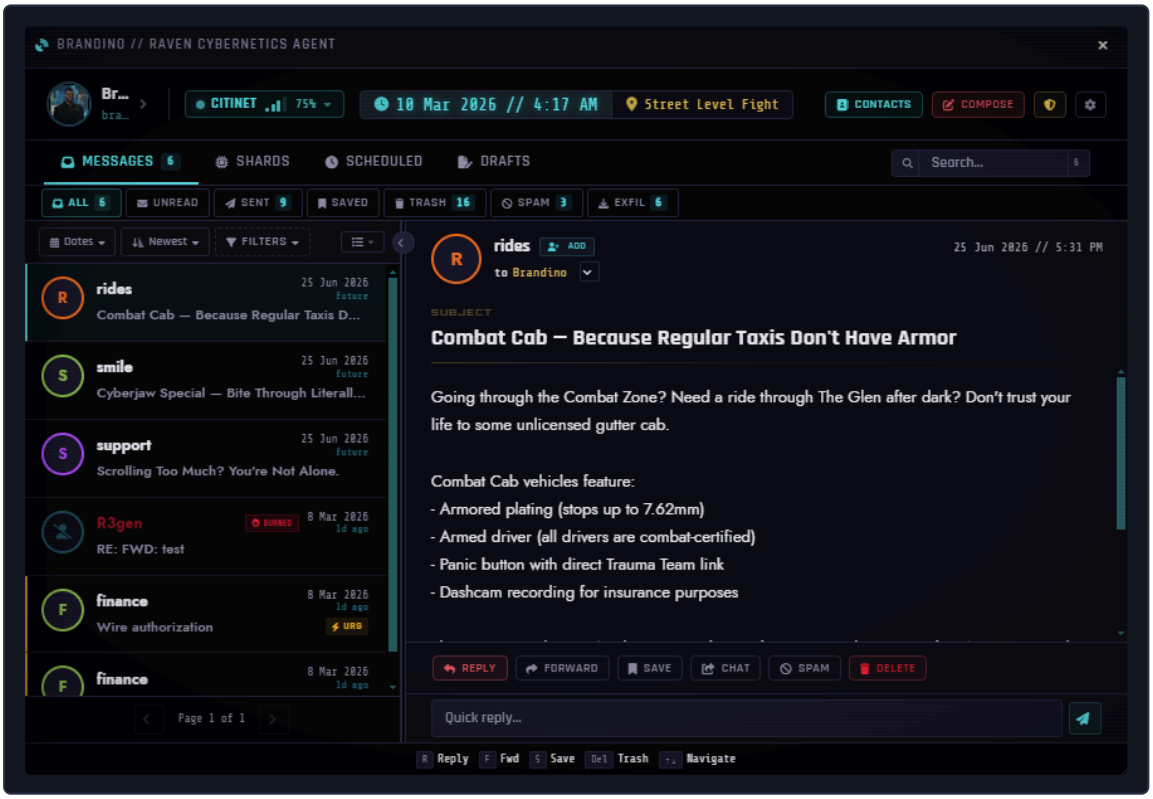
Open this guide again any time with the **?** button at the top of your inbox.

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// PART 01

Your Agent



- The Agent, your in-game phone

Click **Open Inbox** in Foundry's left-hand toolbar (the envelope under the satellite dish icon). The first time, it asks you to:

1. **Pick your character**, if you own more than one.
2. **Pick your email address**: a name plus a domain, like `v.wraith@nightcity.net`. It suggests names based on your character. Your GM decides which domains exist.

That's all the setup there is. NPCs and other players can now message you at that address.

Click your portrait at the top left of the inbox to open the Identity panel: your address, your aliases, your network, your other characters, and Log Out.

The buttons at the top right: Contacts; **Compose** writes a new message, and the ▾ beside it starts a conversation; the **gear** ▾ holds Settings & theme and this guide.

Networks are at the top of the window. You only see networks that reach the scene you're on. A padlock means the network needs a password or a skill check. A network shown as **Jammed** or **Node down** is out on this scene for now. Some messages only open on certain networks.

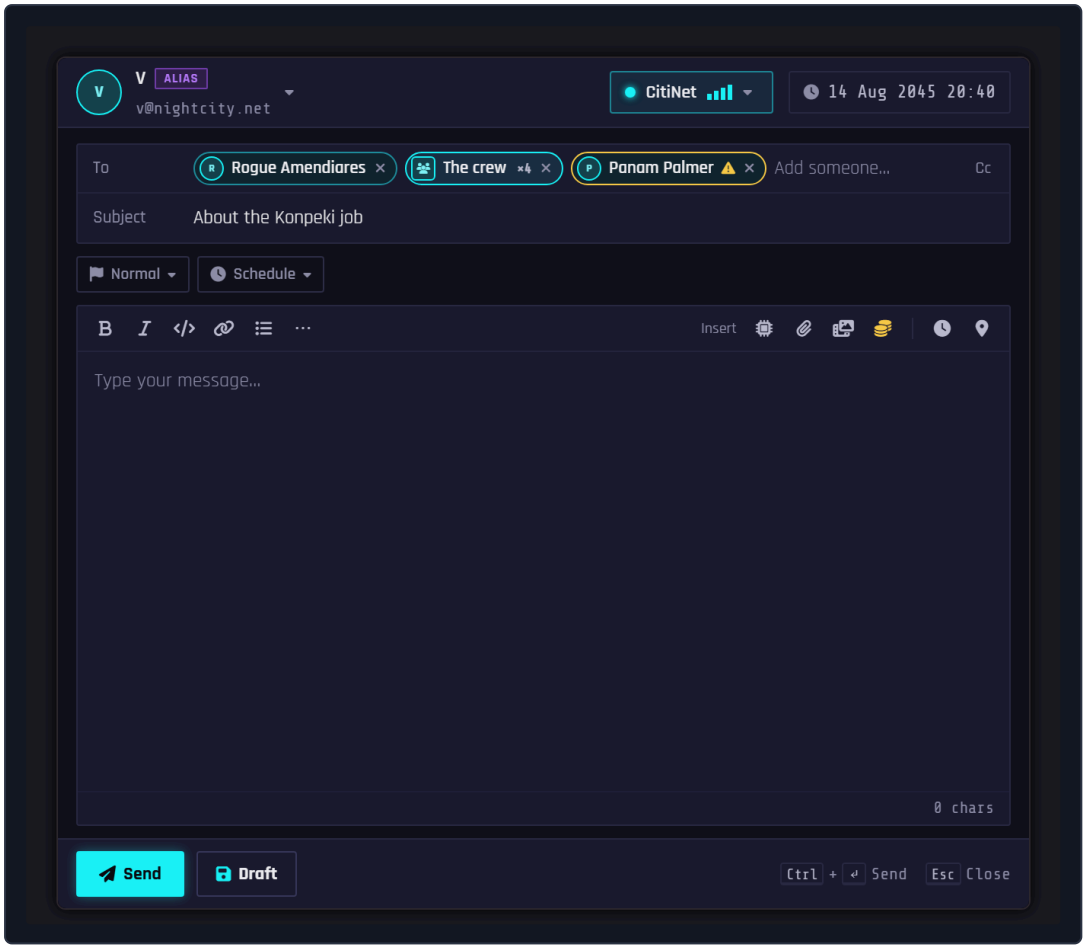
// PART 02

Reading mail

- **Folders:** All, Unread, Sent and Saved sit in the filter row; Drafts, Scheduled, Spam and Trash are behind **More** ▾ (it shows a count when something new is in there). Pick **Unread** for a **Mark all read** button. **Unread** on an open message marks it unread again.
- **Clearing out mail:** press **Select**, tick messages (Shift-click ticks a range; **Select all** takes every page), then **Move to Trash**. A strip says how many went and has **Open Trash** and **Undo**. In Trash you can **Restore** them or **Delete forever**; in Spam, **Not spam** moves them back to your inbox.
- **Threads:** click the **Thread** button on a message to see the whole conversation in one view.
- **Reply All:** a message sent to several people shows a party chip next to the To line and a **Reply All** button beside Reply. A reply can take more people too: type in the To line, or open Cc.
- **Share to chat:** posts a message as a chat card. Anyone reading the card who doesn't have the sender in their contacts gets an **Add contact** button on it.
- **Money:** a message can have eddies attached. Click **Claim** and the money goes to your character sheet. It can only be claimed once.
- **Attached shards:** open them from the message. They're also listed on the **Shards** tab. Its search box finds them by name or by who sent them, and the arrow keys and Enter open one.
- **Keys:** the bar at the bottom of the inbox lists the keys that work on the tab you are on. On **Calls**, / jumps to the number box and Enter calls.
- **Self-destructing messages:** if you get one, read it carefully. It won't be there later.
- **Locked messages:** some are encrypted and take a skill roll to open.

// PART 03

Writing mail



▪ The composer

Click **Compose**. The top line shows who you're sending as, your network and the date. Type a contact's name in **To** and pick from the list. A group's name adds everyone in it.

The chips under the subject are the delivery options, such as priority and scheduling. Click one to open its panel. The toolbar can attach a shard, a file, a picture or video, or eddies.

Drafts. The composer saves what you're writing every half-minute, and **Draft** saves it and closes the window. Your character can hold up to twenty drafts. A new composer always opens empty. Your drafts are under **More** ▾ → **Drafts** in your inbox, or behind the **N drafts** link at the bottom of the composer.

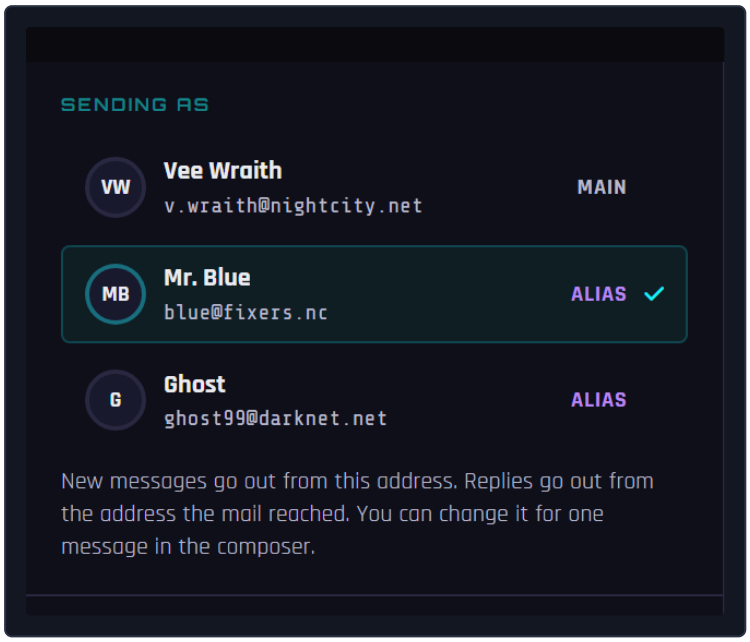
If a message doesn't go through, the composer tells you why and stays open with **Retry**, **Queue** and **Save Draft**. With no signal, Send turns into **Queue**: the message waits and goes out when you're back in range.

> **TIP** "Message queued" and "Message sent" are different things. Queued mail hasn't left yet.

// PART 04

Your addresses and aliases

Your GM can give your character extra addresses: a burner, a cover name, a work account. Each one is an **alias**. Mail to any of them lands in your one inbox. You can't create aliases yourself, so ask your GM if you want one.



- Sending as, in the Identity panel

To choose which address you send from:

1. Click your **portrait** at the top left of the inbox.
2. Under **Sending as**, click the address you want.

Every new message now goes out from that address until you change it, even after you close the game. **Check the From line before you hit Send.** An alias shows a violet **ALIAS** tag there.

For just one message, click your name at the top of the composer and pick another address. Your default doesn't change.

Replies go out from the address the mail reached, so a message sent to your burner gets answered from your burner. You can change that the same way.

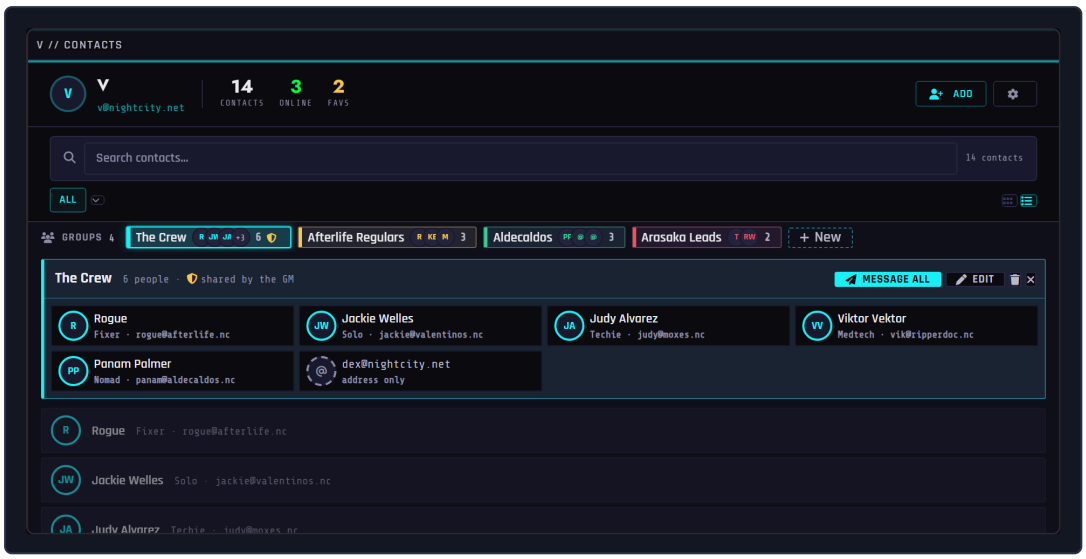
If you have no aliases, you won't see **Sending as** at all.

Burning an address is different. The flame button beside your address permanently burns it and makes you register a new one. Old mail from it shows as [BURNED]. Don't use it to switch to an alias.

// PART 05

Contacts and groups

The **Contacts** button opens your contact book. You can set trust levels, write notes and mark favorites. When a stranger messages you, use **Add to Contacts** on the message. Some contacts are protected by ICE and need a skill check to unlock.

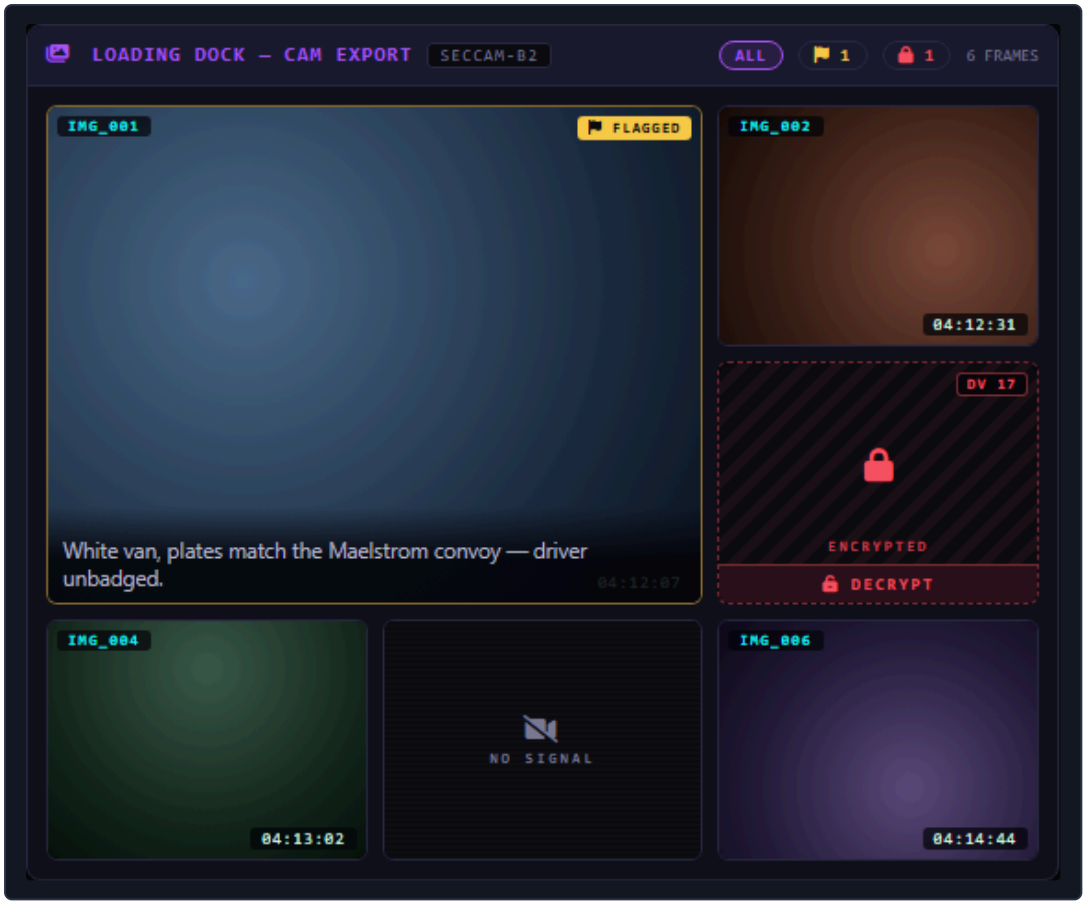


- Groups, under the search bar

Groups sit in a row of chips under the search bar. A group is a named list of your contacts. Make one with **New**, or your GM can hand you one (it shows a shield). Click a chip to see everyone in it, message them all at once, or edit the list.

// PART 06

Shards



- A shard holding a live camera feed

A **data shard** is an item that holds files. Your GM may call them memory chips or something else. You might find one as loot, get one attached to a message, or spot one on the map. Open it from your character sheet, from the message it came with, or from its pin.

A locked shard needs a way in: a password, a key item, a skill check, or a hack. **Failing can cost you.** You may get locked out for a while, get traced, or damage the shard so its files start to go. Some locks bite back.

Inside are files that look like the real thing: messages, chat logs, spreadsheets, bank accounts, password vaults, photos, camera feeds, dossiers, building plans. Parts of a file can be locked or blacked out, and each lock has its own roll.

Analyze (the magnifier on a file's header) rolls to check whether a file really is what it says it is.

Making your own. If your GM allows it, **Encode new** on the inbox's Shards tab starts the Shard Encoder: pick a blank, write the files, optionally lock it, and roll. Forged files take a skill roll, and a poor one leaves signs that someone can find.

// PART 07

Terminals



- A terminal login screen

A **terminal** is a computer you log into: a corp workstation, a ripperdoc's records, a street bulletin board. It might be a pin on the map, a place your token walks into, an item, or a link your GM gives you.

Logging in. Pick an account. It may be open, or need a password, a key item or a skill check. Too many misses and you're locked out for a while. Some accounts aren't listed, and you can only reach them by typing a username you learned somewhere else. A login lasts until you close the window.

Inside, a switch picks **Mail** or **Files**, unless the machine lays things out differently. On a machine with a command line, click a folder or hint, or type a number to open that row, `cd` to open a folder, `?` for the commands, and `logout` to change account.

Taking data. Depending on the machine, you can copy a file to your Agent (it lands in your **Exfil** folder), burn it to a shard, forward it, leak it to chat, sell it, or wipe it. Some of these take a roll, and a miss gets noticed. A denied action tells you why. You can't copy a live camera feed, but you can save a frame, and you may be able to loop or cut the camera.

Operator tools. The **OPS** menu next to the operator chip holds **Upload** (leave a file or program on the machine) and **System Sweep** (look for what someone else left there). A sweep only shows what your roll was good enough to find. It won't tell you if it missed something.

// PART 08

Network nodes



▪ A node console

A **node** is a physical box that carries a network into a place: a router, a relay, a mast. Open one to see its signal, its state and what's passing through. Anyone can **Connect** to its network from there.

A netrunner can **Jack in** with a skill roll. Inside, you get a number of **moves** based on your rank. Depending on your rank and your GM's rules, you can switch the node off or on, jam it, tap it for copies of passing mail, open a backdoor past the network's login, insert a program from a shard, sweep for what others left, or wipe your line from its log.

Moves stay spent. Jacking out and back in resumes the same session until it runs out, and coming back raises the node's alert. A failed jack-in counts toward a lockout.

// PART 09

Calls

Open **Calls** in your inbox. The dialer is on the left, and your calls are on the right. If you have no number yet, Calls walks you through getting one.

Your number. A number says where it was issued, not where you are now, and it stays with you when you move. Hover any number to see what it means.

YOU DIAL	WHEN
`WAT-4471`	Same city: the district and four digits
`SF NFF-2210`	A nearby city: add the city

YOU DIAL	WHEN
`+14 DAL CEN-3345`	Far away: add a + code for the region

Your line. The My line card shows your full number, and whether your voicemail, greeting and ringer are on. If your GM lets you, you can add a second line or a burner there. Retiring a line ends that number for good.

Your greeting. Click **Greeting** on the My line card to choose what callers hear when you don't pick up: the default, your own words, your words read out, or **Audio** (record up to 20 seconds, or give a link to a sound file). Read out uses each caller's own computer voice, so it sounds different for everyone. Audio sounds the same for everyone. Each of your numbers has its own greeting.

Making a call. Type a number or a contact's name, or tap the pad, then press Call. Letters work on the keypad, so 9-2-8 spells WAT. Calling a company's main number reaches its switchboard: you hear its greeting, and you can pick a listed extension, type one you know, or press 0 for the operator or to leave a message. To skip the switchboard, add the extension when you dial: `MIL-0100 x17`.

During a call. You can talk out loud at the table, type, or dictate if your browser allows it. Your GM chooses which of these are available. Calls need signal, so a dead zone or a downed node can cut you off. If the call covers something on your screen, drag it by its picture, its name or the grip at its left edge; double-click the grip to put it back.

Finding old calls. The tabs are **Calls**, **Missed**, **Voicemail** and **Contacts**. Calls are folded by date, with today open. Search finds names, numbers, networks and words said on a call, and **Show** narrows the list to one kind. The up-and-down arrow opens or closes every date.

Saving a caller. A call from a number you have not saved has a contact button. If the call came from someone already in your contacts, it adds this number to them. Otherwise it saves a new contact, already filled in with the name and picture their call showed.

Withheld numbers. Press the crosshair on a withheld call, live or in the log, to trace it. It is a skill check. When it works, a **Trace result** card in chat gives you the number, and the name when the line has one. A burner gives you the number only.

Sharing your number. Use the share button on My line to give your number to another character. A contact shows only what you were given, so you might have someone's address and not their number.

Payphones. Some places have a payphone pin on the map. Stand at it and double-click it: lift the handset, punch the number on the little screen (or press **Book** for your contacts) and press **OK**. Whoever you call sees the payphone, not you, and the call stays out of your own call log. Payphones are wired, so they work where your Agent has no signal. **SPKR** lets everyone standing there follow the call; without it, they only see that you're on the phone. When a payphone rings near you, a prompt offers **Pick up** if you're standing at it.

Emergency calls. If your character has a Trauma Team plan, dialling Trauma Team calls them out. A Lawman can also call Backup from Calls. Help arrives in a few rounds, and a small strip at the top of

the screen counts down.

// PART 10

Conversations

If your GM has them switched on, a conversation is a group chat that sits in your inbox with your mail, by its latest line. **Conversations** in the filter row shows only them.

Mail or a conversation? A message is something you send: it has a subject, and it can carry eddies, encryption, a shard or a self-destruct. A conversation is something you are in. It is plain lines, back and forth. **Send as mail** in a chat opens the composer addressed to everyone there, for when you need what mail can do.

Starting one. Open the ▾ beside **Compose** at the top of your inbox and pick **New conversation**, add people from your contacts or a group, and pick who you join as. **That name is fixed for this conversation.** If you join as an alias, everyone there only ever sees the alias.

Writing. Enter sends, and Shift+Enter starts a new line. The smiley in the box adds an emoji. The **+** adds a picture, your number or a contact. A contact locked with ICE can't be shared. Someone who receives a contact presses **Save contact**, and it only adds what they were missing.

People. Members lists who is in it. Anyone can add someone. New people see only what is said after they join. When you leave or are removed, you keep what you had and get nothing new. Only whoever started it can rename it or remove people.

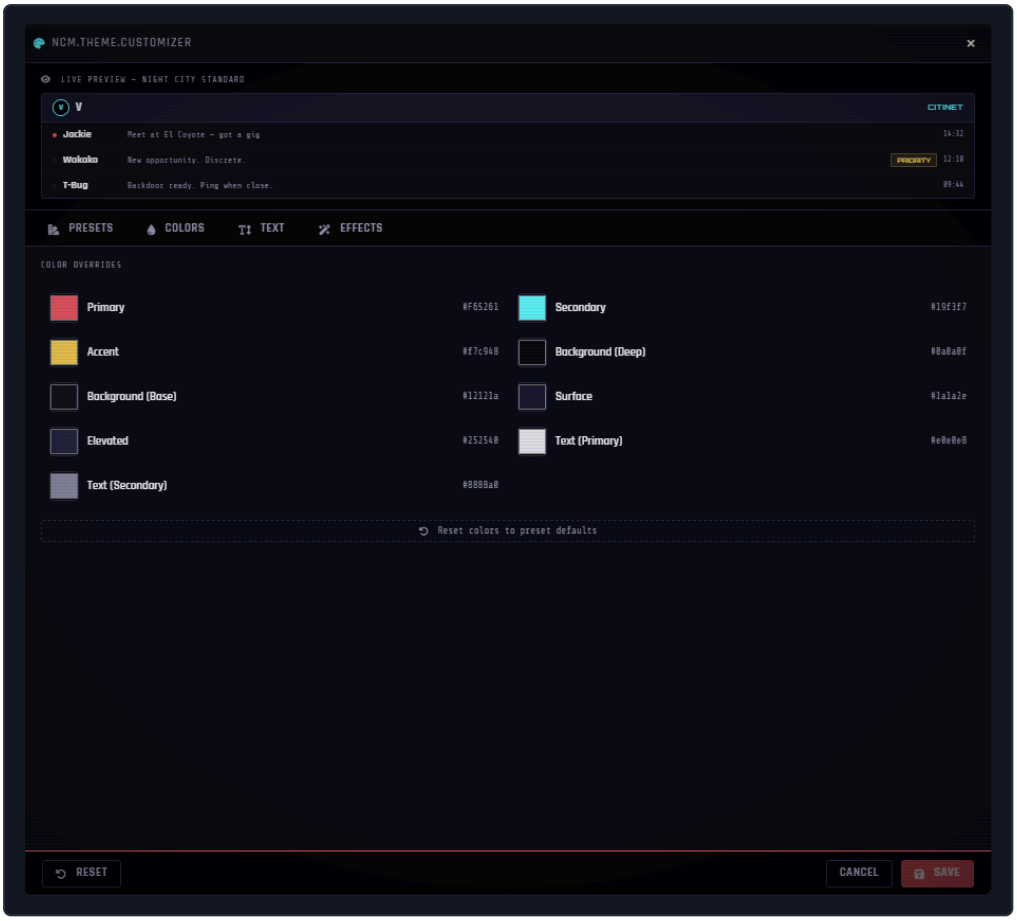
Notifications. You get one toast per conversation, which updates as lines arrive, and one sound until you read it. The bell at the top mutes a conversation.

No connection. With no GM online or no signal, your lines wait and send when they can. The GM can read conversations, the same as mail.

> **TIP** conversations don't turn up in the shard, terminal or trace tools. Mail is still what you forward, encrypt or leave on a machine.

// PART 11

Make it yours



- The Theme Customizer

The **gear** ▾ menu in your inbox opens the Theme Customizer (and this guide). Only you see your theme.

- **Colors, fonts and wallpaper**, and a custom name for your Agent.
- **Text Size** also makes the pop-up dialogs bigger. **Contrast** helps on a bright screen.
- **CRT Film** puts a screen film over your windows. **Film on terminals & shards** dims it or turns it off on machines the GM has styled, on your screen only.
- **Sound** volume, or turn sounds off.

Before a roll, a small panel shows what you're adding up, what you have to beat, your chance, and steppers to spend **Luck** or add a modifier your GM gave you. A tie fails: you have to beat the number. **Ask Before Rolling** in Module Settings turns the panel off.

Showing the table. On a terminal, shard or node, the **eye** on the window's title bar lets the other players watch a read-only copy of your screen. Click it again to stop. Passwords stay hidden. When someone else shares, a **Watch** chip appears at the top of your screen. Your GM decides whether this is available.

More than one character? Terminals, shards and nodes act as your **operator**: the character who rolls, pays and gets paid. An **operator chip** shows up on those screens when you own several. Check it before you roll. If the wrong character is picked, the wrong character gets the money.

// REFERENCE

If something seems broken

A GM has to be online. When you claim money, decrypt a file, jack into a node or schedule a message, the change goes through the GM's computer. If no GM is connected, it won't happen, and the module says so. Your own composing and reading still work.

You can't see a network, message or file. You may be on the wrong scene or network. Check the network button at the top of your inbox.

Reply is missing. Some senders are one-way system addresses, and some anonymous mail can't be answered.

The wrong character got something. Check the operator chip, and which character your inbox is open as.

Still stuck? Tell your GM what you clicked and what it said. Admin → Messages shows them where each message went and why.